

AMIT SHAH, *Union Minister of Home, Minister of Cooperation*

The Union government is identifying vacuum areas in the cooperatives sector and will establish 200,000 Primary Agricultural Credit Societies (PACS) across the country, the Union home minister and minister of cooperation Amit Shah said at the summit. This, he added, would ensure a cooperative society in all the village panchayats in India.

"We have computerised all PACS, and almost 52,000 of...71,000 PACs have gone live. Model bylaws have been prepared at the central level, and I am happy that all states have accepted them. Under this, the PACS can do 24 types of work," Shah said. "They were earlier into short-term agriculture finance, and now they can also be CSCs (Common Service Centres), Jan Aushadhi Kendras, petrol pumps and gas distributors. They would maintain water supply schemes, build godowns, run cooperative taxis, and make air and rail bookings."

In three years, the government has launched the National Cooperative Exports Ltd, National Cooperative Organics Ltd and Bharatiya Beej Sahakari Samiti Ltd. These cooperatives will sell agricultural produce in world markets, and the profits will be directly credited to the farmers' bank accounts. Organic products will be certified and sold under the 'Bharat Organic' brand in local and international markets. This will ensure gains for farmers as well as the end-users who will get certified organic products. Shah expressed confidence that in the next 10 years, these three new cooperatives will grow into major institutions like Amul, NAFED, IFFCO and KRIBHCO that serve farmers.

"To strengthen our *annadatas* and create a robust ecosystem to back it, PM Modi has created the Ministry of Cooperation

In fisheries, 44 deep-sea trawlers are being supported through cooperatives. The dairy sector is also being strengthened under the White Revolution 2.0

A national taxi service will be launched. Here, a driver will not just be connected to it, but will also be the owner of Bharat co-operative taxi and will get profits straight into his bank account"